becoming the first Indian to be a certified Associate of the Institute of Bankers in London.

Sorabji started the day early around 5.30 am with a visit to the bazaar. This habit persisted throughout his life and even when he had arrived in life (as Sir Sorabji Pochkhanawala) he would visit the bazaar to buy fish, fruit, and other provisions. He then attended a class on book-keeping, returned home to change, and left to give violin lessons. Sorabji partook of a hurried breakfast at an Irani restaurant and by 10 am he reported to the bank for work. He worked till late in the evening and often on holidays and Sundays. With his brother as the head clerk, Sorabji had an opportunity of learning something about the foreign exchange business, a closely guarded secret in those days among the foreign banks. It is said that at that time there were only three Indians who understood arbitrage operations: the head clerk of the Chartered Bank, Hirjibhoy who succeeded to this post in 1905, and the head clerk of the Mercantile Bank. After the day's work was over and the bank was deserted he would study some aspect of banking with Hirjibhoy. After dinner he would join his family in a music session. Here, as in every other endeavour, Sorabji was in search of perfection and he was always on the lookout for instructors for the violin and harmonium.

There was little time for relaxation and the usual pastimes that attract the young were not for him. This was not because Sorabji was an overly serious person but because he simply could not spare the time. Serious and sober Sorabji may have been, but he was also an amiable young man with a friendly disposition. Absorbed as he was in advancing his own prospects, Sorabji was always aware of the family's slender financial resources and gave private tuitions to supplement the family income. He tutored the young sons of R.B. Vissonji Khimji in book-keeping and commercial subjects and was treated like a member of the Khimji family. The sons who became proprietors of the firm of Messrs Vissonji & Sons freely acknowledged their debt to Sorabji and in later life Sorabji spoke of Seth Vissonji as his patron.

During his time at the Bank of India, Sorabji received an offer from a certain Lalchand of the then well-known firm, Gulab Singh & Sons of Lahore and Calcutta to join his firm on the princely salary of ₹300 (Sorabji was earning only ₹75 then). Sorabji met Lalchand on the street when the latter asked him for directions to the nearest post office. The two struck up a